

Text for number 1-7

Everyone has it tough during the COVID-19 pandemic, and we are all in the same boat - this has been a common refrain throughout the crisis. It is true that we are all on board the Titanic together. However, some are riding first class, some are riding third class, and others are in the galley below rowing... Oh, and there are not enough lifeboats to go round.

In reality, the super-rich are not only shielded from this crisis by their wealth, which enables them to shelter from the virus on superyachts or escape it on private jets, some are even enjoying an unprecedented bounty during these difficult times. This is especially the case in the United States.

During the coronavirus crisis, US billionaires accrued a huge windfall of more than 434 dollar bn in the two months between mid-March and mid-May. This comes at a time when at least 40 million Americans are out of work, struggling to get by, and 256 million people around the world are at risk of dying of hunger. While front-line workers risk their health and lives to keep society functioning and care for the sick, the biggest financial winner by far is the world's richest man, Jeff Bezos, who has seen his fortune expand by nearly 35 dollar bn thanks to the surge in the value of his company Amazon, as people trapped in lockdown have turned to online shopping.

Whenever anyone, including myself, criticises the obscene wealth of billionaires, there are those who rush in to defend them, arguing that critics are just envious and that billionaires deserve this success and earned their vast fortunes.

Like a superhero origin myth, there is a typical narrative that surrounds billionaires, especially those in the tech industry. It goes something like this: X, working in their bedroom/garage/dorm, came up with a brilliant idea, against the odds, brought it to market and is now enjoying the fruits of their brilliance. However, is the acumen of these entrepreneurs really worth so much more than everyone else's labour - combined?

Source: *Aljazeera.com* (with modifications)

No. 1

What does the expression "... others are in the galley below rowing" in paragraph 1 mean?

- A. The ship is going to sink sooner than expected.
- B. The lower class of society are preparing to riot and disrupt the situation.
- C. The lower class of society are gravely struggling to get by.
- D. The upper class is safe because society will eventually survive the crisis.
- E. The upper class should support the lower class in the middle of crisis.

No. 2

What is the purpose of paragraph 2 and 3?

- A. To justify the sacrifices made by the lower class with economic growth
- B. To show the indistinguishable situations between lower and upper class
- C. To provide context of why the elites need to be protected for the economy
- D. To exhibit the earnings of billionaires in the United States
- E. To contrast the divergent situation between the elite class and everyone else

No. 3

What can be inferred from the text above?

- A. The socioeconomic inequality in the US is atrocious.
- B. Billionaires are heartless sociopaths that leech off society, especially in the US.
- C. The current economic system is detrimental to the upper class.
- D. Socioeconomic inequality has slightly improved during the crisis.
- E. During the crisis, the US economy came crumbling down.

No. 4

Which paragraph shows the best evidence for the answer in the previous question?

- A. Paragraph 1
- B. Paragraph 2
- C. Paragraph 3
- D. Paragraph 4
- E. Paragraph 5

No. 5

What is the writer's stance regarding billionaires?

- A. Billionaires should not exist to equalize society.
- B. Billionaires should redistribute their huge wealth to society.
- C. The elites do not deserve any of their wealth.
- D. In the middle of crisis, they should stop gaining more profits.
- E. The worthiness of their ridiculous wealth needs to be challenged.

No. 6

The word 'acumen' in the last paragraph most nearly means

- A. Belligerence
- B. Intelligence
- C. Immorality
- D. Ineptness
- E. Guile

No. 7

According to the text, a part of the rich is reveling in even more wealth than any time before the pandemic. Is this statement true? Which part supports this statement?

- A. Yes, it's mentioned that they're shielded from the pandemic effect by their wealth.
- B. No, it's mentioned that more than 40 million people in the US are losing their jobs.
- C. Yes, it's mentioned that Jeff Bezos even added 35 billion dollar to his wealth during the pandemic.
- D. No, it's not mentioned nor implied anywhere in the text that the rich are gaining more than before.
- E. Yes, it's mentioned that some of the rich are even enjoying an unprecedented bounty.

Text for number 8-14

Do you play video games? If so, you aren't alone. Video games are becoming more common and are increasingly enjoyed by adults. The average age of gamers has been increasing. Changing technology also means that more people are exposed to video games. Many committed gamers play on desktop computers or consoles, but a new breed of casual gamers has emerged, who play on smartphones and tablets at spare moments throughout the day, like their morning commute. So, we know that video games are an increasingly common form of entertainment, but do they have any effect on our brains and behavior?

Over the years, the media have made various sensationalist claims about video games and their effect on our health and happiness. "Games have sometimes been praised or demonized, often without real data backing up those claims. Moreover, gaming is a popular activity, so everyone seems to have strong opinions on the topic," says Marc Palaus, first author on the review, recently published in *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*.

Palaus and his colleagues wanted to see if any trends had emerged from the research to date concerning how video games affect the structure and activity of our brains. They collected the results from 116 scientific studies, 22 of which looked at structural changes in the brain and 100 of which looked at changes in brain functionality and/or behavior.

The studies show that playing video games can change how our brains perform, and even their structure. For example, playing video games affects our attention, and some studies found that gamers show improvements in several types of attention, such as sustained attention or selective attention. The brain regions involved in attention are also more efficient in gamers and require less activation to sustain attention on demanding tasks.

Source: sciencedaily.com

No. 8

What can be inferred from the passage above?

- A. Gamers are more likely to have brain damage due to the change in their brain structures.
- B. Given its benefits, gaming will now be continuously praised on the media.
- C. Gamers will find it easier to focus on tasks that require a lot of energy or attention.
- D. Gaming will continue to become increasingly popular and will render other forms of entertainment useless.
- E. Gamers are healthier and happier compared to people who don't play video games.

No. 9

Why does the writer use the word "*sensationalist*" in paragraph 2?

- A. Because video games are getting more popular among adults
- B. Because games have been praised and demonized
- C. Because games have been covered a lot by the media
- D. Because video games are a sensational phenomenon
- E. Because the media has made extreme claims, usually with no actual evidence

No. 10

What can we say about the author's objective in writing this article?

- A. The writer denies any claims on the negative effects of games.
- B. The writer agrees that games ruin our brain functions.
- C. The writer proves the media's claims on the negative effects of games.
- D. The writer explains how video games change the brain's performance.
- E. The writer shows that video games alter the brain's performance and structure.

No. 11

Which of the following questions cannot be answered by the passage?

- A. How did the media frame video games over the years?
- B. What are video games criticized for?
- C. Are video games gaining popularity among adults?
- D. Why are video games so polarizing?
- E. What are the advantages of playing video games?

No. 12

Which option uses the word "committed" in the same way that it is used in sentence 6?

- A. Ken committed a peculiar and uncharacteristic mistake.
- B. After throwing a tantrum in public, Amber is finally committed to a psych ward.
- C. Felix is committed to continuing his study in the education field.
- D. Charlie has committed much of his career to the gaming industry.
- E. My family has been committed members of the city council.

No. 13

What can we say about the result of the study?

- A. The researchers collected the results from previous studies examining brain structure and functionality.
- B. More than changing how our brains perform, playing games can also alter brain structure.
- C. The study shows that gamers have better performance in conducting cognitive tasks compared to non-gamers.
- D. The number of gamers is increasing due to the inclusion of the new type of gamers who play on mobile devices.
- E. Playing video games on mobile devices can alter the functionality and structure of the brain.

No. 14

What is the significance of the expression "...but a new breed of casual gamers has emerged..."?

- A. To illustrate the important role of mobile gamers in the study
- B. To introduce one of the types of gamers examined in the study
- C. To introduce the group that promotes the expansion of video games
- D. To specify which type of gamers is included in the study
- E. To introduce the group of gamers that is on the rise in popularity

Text for number 15-20

Scientists from the Cetacean Ecology Group at the University of Queensland, and colleagues, studied song patterns of humpback whales from various regions between 2009 and 2015 and found that not only do they collaboratively create songs within a defined population, but they also share those songs over the ocean waves, where they are picked up by disparate populations from other regions. Over the six years scientists were observing whale populations, they identified six unique songs which were transmitted eastward beginning with the west Australian population and traveling to east Australia.

The songs follow a complex, language-like structure. Individual animals sing compositions consisting of moans, cries, and other vocalizations called *song units*. Song units are composed into larger *phrases*, which are repeated to form *themes*. Different themes are produced in a consistent sequence to form a *song cycle* that are then repeated for hours, or even days. Over time, songs evolve through small changes which are adopted by all singers in a population. As a result, songs change year over year and vary by population.

It was proposed that song transmission might occur as humpbacks leave their breeding grounds and migrate to foraging grounds close to Antarctica. On that journey, a male humpback may end up swimming alongside males from another population. When they hear his radically different song, they may borrow some themes or steal the entire song. They will keep singing their new song when they return to their breeding grounds.

Notably, no one is certain why the whales sing. Most research suggests a courtship display, a conclusion supported at least partially by the fact that singing is the exclusive ability of male humpbacks. Embellishing a song may be a way for him to stand out. "These big changes jump out of the water at us, to our ears," Dr. Garland said. "So I would assume they would be noticeable to females."

Source: *syfy.com* (with modifications)

No. 15

Which of the following statements best expresses the main idea of the passage?

- A. Changes to humpback whale song may occur when males embellish their own song through addition, substitution or deletion at any hierarchical level.
- B. Humpback songs can morph and migrate within and between whale populations in a stepwise fashion.
- C. Underwater recordings have revealed that humpback males sing during migration between breeding and feeding habitats.
- D. Whale songs travel in a linear pattern with certain variances as some individuals are sung differently with very minor differences.
- E. When songs have significant changes performed by an individual whale, other pod members apply the said changes.

No. 16

All of the following can be inferred from the passage, except ...

- A. Male humpback whales go through a cultural revolution by picking up new songs when sharing the same space as other whales.
- B. During the song, humpbacks produce an intricate series of sounds that can be deconstructed into hierarchical elements.
- C. Some song learning can occur between whale populations that are in close proximity and may be able to hear the other population's song.
- D. Humpback whales can learn an entire song pattern from another population very quickly, without leaving anything out.
- E. One whale finds mating success by tinkering with the song style, the rest of the guys imitate it to better their chances.

No. 17

According to the passage, humpback songs have similar structure to that of a language because

- A. it is organized in a specific pattern using a clear set of rules
- B. it displays variations among geographically separated populations
- C. it can convey information and assert dominance with other males
- D. it evolves and spreads across populations over course of years
- E. it is made up of repeated phrases and themes

No. 18

As used in the last paragraph, the word "embellishing" is closest in meaning to

- A. taking something without permission and without intending to return it
- B. forming something by putting parts together or combining elements
- C. creating something more difficult by causing it to be more complex
- D. making something more interesting by adding extra features
- E. representing something as being than it really is

No. 19

It is most reasonable to conclude that the complexity of humpback songs can be analyzed by measuring

- I. the sound the whales make
- II. the length of the sound patterns
- III. the duration of a song session
- IV. the distance of whale migratory route

- A. I and II
- B. II and III
- C. III and IV
- D. I, II, and III
- E. All of the above

No. 20

"When they hear his radically different song, they may borrow some themes or steal the entire song."

What meaning does the modal 'may' carry in this context?

- A. It shows permission.
- B. It shows suggestion.
- C. It shows possibility.
- D. It shows polite offer.
- E. It shows ability.